

POINT OF VIEW · 2026

Disclosure has outgrown the *spreadsheet*.

A point of view for risk officers on IFRS S1/S2 readiness under UAE Decree-Law No. 11.

THE ARGUMENT

From annual exercise to *continuous* obligation.

Why sustainability reporting now belongs to the risk function, and what the standards actually demand of the data.

IFRS S1 and S2 turn sustainability reporting into a controls problem. The standards put governance, strategy, risk management and metrics on the same footing as financial reporting. UAE Decree-Law No. 11 gives the requirement force in the Emirates. What was an annual exercise is becoming a continuous one.

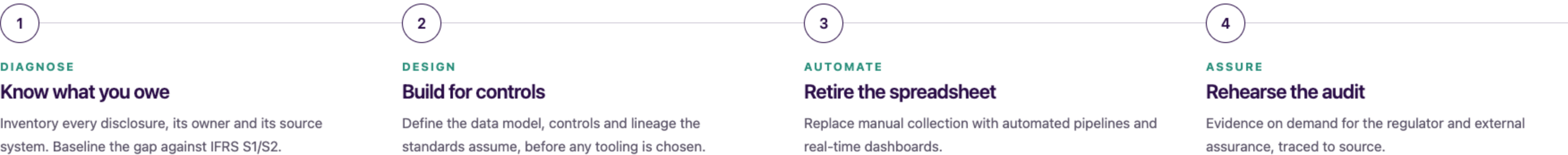
Manual collection cannot carry regulatory weight. Data gathered by email and assembled in Excel has no lineage, no controls and no repeatability. At a large UAE bank, manual ESG collection consumed the team every cycle; automating it later returned more than 1,200 hours a year to the business.

The fix is a pipeline, not a taskforce. Automated collection with real-time dashboards replaced that bank's spreadsheet estate, cutting processing time by 70% and giving compliance an answer it can reproduce on demand, aligned to IFRS S1/S2 and global standards.

“A number you cannot reproduce *on demand* is not a disclosure. It is a risk.”

THE FRAMEWORK

Four phases to *audit-ready*.



CASE STUDY

70%

REDUCTION IN PROCESSING TIME

Automated ESG reporting & compliance

A large UAE bank

THE CHALLENGE

Manual, Excel-based ESG collection across the bank: slow, error-prone and difficult to evidence against IFRS S1/S2 and UAE Decree-Law No. 11.

WHAT WE DID

Replaced the spreadsheet estate with Alteryx-powered automated collection and real-time dashboards, with controls and lineage built in.

THE OUTCOME

A 70% reduction in processing time, 1,200+ hours saved, and full compliance with IFRS S1/S2, UAE Decree-Law No. 11 and global standards.

70%
Reduction in processing time

1,200+
Hours saved each year

Real-time
Dashboards replacing Excel collection

Four moves before the next reporting *cycle*.

01

Inventory the disclosures

Every metric, its owner and its source system. A number without an owner is not a disclosure.

02

Retire the spreadsheet pipeline

Email-and-Excel collection cannot evidence lineage. Plan its retirement explicitly.

03

Automate collection first

Pipelines and dashboards before narrative polish. The numbers carry the filing.

04

Rehearse the audit

Ask for any figure on demand, trace it to source, and time how long the answer takes.

Leading with clarity.
Delivering the *difference*.

Start a conversation

ABOUT ASPIRO

Aspiro is an independent, investor-free management consultancy for GCC financial institutions, founded in Dubai in 2015 with offices in Riyadh and London. Its partners carry 100+ years of senior leadership experience, backed by a network of 8,000+ specialists.

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